

green tech examples and projects that can help usher in a brighter future for this planet and its inhabitants in the coming years.

Green initiatives around the world

The looming energy crisis is a global problem, and if not tackled it will have repercussions for everyone around the world. With that in mind, let's take a look at some noteworthy initiatives around the world that we are looking for

1) The Green Grid

The Green Grid is a non-profit organization that stresses on IT companies to become greener and more efficient. It explains itself as, "With more than 175 member companies around the world, The Green Grid seeks to unite global industry efforts, create a common set of metrics, and develop technical resources and educational tools to further its goals." The initiative seeks collaboration between multiple companies towards better energy practices.

Participating IT companies work towards the shift to solar energy, enhancing data center efficiency and other green policy implementations across their offices to minimize their carbon footprint and cause minimal harm to the ecosystem.

2) Google's initiatives

Google's probably one of the most pro-active IT company in the field of greener tech research, adoption and deployment. It's working on renewable energy efforts not for its own offices alone, but investing plenty of money in developing large scale rooftop wind and solar panel installations which can produce up to 1.7GW of power, enough to power 350,000 US homes, Google claims.

Along with this, Google also has some product-level examples. It has an interesting chart on how emails hosted on Gmails servers (essentially in the cloud) consume less energy than emails hosted on a local server (in an office setup, for instance), simply because emails hosted on the cloud are across several data centers which are much more efficiently managed than a local server.

For more information on Google's green initiatives, visit www.google.com/green/bigpicture

3) Off-the-grid

This is an innovative American trend that's steadily evolving into a global movement. Off-the-grid simply means not connected to the grid or conven-